

A KEEPSAKE FOR YOUR RESCUE DOG

Gotcha Day Memory Bundle

Celebrate the day your paths crossed

A printable keepsake to mark — and re-celebrate,
year after year — your dog's adoption anniversary.

FORM & FERN

Adoption Certificate

Fill this in once, then frame it or keep it with their things — the official start of your story together.

- ☐ Dog's full name and any nicknames you've already given them
- ☐ Gotcha Day date — the day they officially came home
- ☐ Where they came from — shelter, rescue group, or foster home name
- ☐ Their approximate age and breed or mix, as best known
- ☐ Who was there the day you brought them home
- ☐ The very first thing you said to them
- ☐ The very first thing they did once they felt safe
- ☐ One word that captured how that day felt
- ☐ Signed and dated by their new family

Our Gotcha Day Story

Write it while it's fresh — this page becomes more precious every year you re-read it.

- ☐ How you first found out about this dog
- ☐ What made you say yes to this particular dog
- ☐ What the drive or walk home was like
- ☐ What their very first moment inside your home looked like
- ☐ Where they chose to go first — a corner, a bed, your lap
- ☐ What surprised you most about them on day one
- ☐ Who they warmed up to first
- ☐ What you were most nervous about that day
- ☐ One sentence you'd want to remember about this day forever

Before & After: Photo Memory Page

Print this page and glue in real photos, or note where you've saved them digitally for each slot below.

- ☐ Photo slot 1: The very first photo you took of them
- ☐ Photo slot 2: The drive or walk home
- ☐ Photo slot 3: Their first night in their new spot
- ☐ Photo slot 4: The first time they looked truly relaxed
- ☐ Photo slot 5: One year later, looking and feeling like family
- ☐ Noted the date each photo was taken underneath it
- ☐ Picked a consistent spot to photograph them each Gotcha Day
- ☐ Saved digital copies somewhere easy to find next year
- ☐ Printed or ordered physical copies of your favorites

Firsts Milestone Tracker

The early "firsts" go by fast — capture the date and a quick memory for each one.

- ☐ First full night of sleep through, no pacing or whining
- ☐ First walk where they seemed to genuinely enjoy it
- ☐ First time they came when called, unprompted
- ☐ First time they played with a toy on their own
- ☐ First time they sought you out just for affection
- ☐ First vet visit as part of your family
- ☐ First time meeting another dog calmly
- ☐ First time you saw their personality really come through
- ☐ First time it felt like they'd always been yours

One Year Later: A Reflection

However much time has passed, this page is for looking back at how far you've both come.

- ☐ What's different about them now compared to Gotcha Day?
- ☐ What's different about you as their person?
- ☐ What's a habit or quirk that's become completely normal to you now?
- ☐ What's a moment from this year you don't want to forget?
- ☐ What's something you were worried about that turned out fine?
- ☐ What's a way they've surprised you this year?
- ☐ What's something you'd tell yourself back on Gotcha Day?
- ☐ What are you most looking forward to in the year ahead together?
- ☐ What's the biggest thing you're grateful for this year?

Yearly Gotcha Day Tradition Ideas

Pick a few to make an annual tradition — check off the ones you want to try this year.

- ☐ Retake the same "after" photo in the same spot each year
- ☐ Give them one special new toy just for the occasion
- ☐ Make or buy a special meal or treat just for the day
- ☐ Take an extra-long or new walk somewhere they'll love
- ☐ Write this year's entry in the Memory Keepsake Log
- ☐ Donate to the shelter or rescue they came from, in their honor
- ☐ Take a family photo together to mark the year
- ☐ Share their story with someone who hasn't heard it yet
- ☐ Do absolutely nothing different and just enjoy the day with them

A Letter To My Dog

Write them a letter on this Gotcha Day. Keep it, and maybe write a new one every year.

- ☐ Start with why you're grateful they're yours
- ☐ Mention one specific memory from this year
- ☐ Mention something about them that always makes you laugh
- ☐ Mention something they've taught you without meaning to
- ☐ Mention a hard moment you got through together
- ☐ Mention what you hope for the year ahead
- ☐ Mention something you want them to always know, if they could read it
- ☐ Sign it and date it
- ☐ Tuck it away with this year's photos to read again next year

Favorite Things About You

A lighthearted page to capture the small, specific things that make them them.

- ☐ Their favorite spot in the house
- ☐ Their favorite toy or object
- ☐ Their favorite person and why (be honest)
- ☐ Their funniest habit or quirk
- ☐ Their favorite walk or outdoor spot
- ☐ Their favorite treat
- ☐ The sound or word that gets the biggest reaction
- ☐ Their most "them" facial expression
- ☐ The thing about them you'd never trade for anything

Gotcha Day Celebration Checklist

A simple, low-pressure checklist for the day itself — pick what fits, skip the rest.

- ☐ Picked a date to celebrate (their actual Gotcha Day or closest weekend)
- ☐ Planned a special walk, park visit, or outing they'll enjoy
- ☐ Picked out a small new toy, treat, or accessory
- ☐ Set aside time for extra one-on-one attention that day
- ☐ Took this year's "after" photo in your chosen spot
- ☐ Filled in this year's row in the Memory Keepsake Log
- ☐ Shared a photo or story with friends or family who love them too
- ☐ Kept the day calm and low-key if that's what they'd enjoy most
- ☐ Told them, out loud, how glad you are they're yours

Memory Keepsake Log

Come back to this page every Gotcha Day and add a new row — a growing record across the years.

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- ☐ Year 1: Date, their age, and one favorite memory from the year
 - ☐ Year 2: Date, their age, and one favorite memory from the year
 - ☐ Year 3: Date, their age, and one favorite memory from the year
 - ☐ Year 4: Date, their age, and one favorite memory from the year
 - ☐ Year 5: Date, their age, and one favorite memory from the year
 - ☐ Noted any new habits, favorites, or personality changes each year
 - ☐ Noted any milestones — new sibling, new home, new adventures
 - ☐ Kept this page with the photo memory page for a full annual snapshot
 - ☐ Reread past years' entries before writing this year's
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Gratitude Reflection

A closing page for whenever you need a reminder of why this day matters.

- ☐ Named one way your life is better with them in it
- ☐ Named one way you think their life is better with you in it
- ☐ Reminded yourself that Gotcha Day is worth celebrating like a birthday
- ☐ Reminded yourself that adjustment struggles, if there were any, don't erase this joy
- ☐ Thought of one other rescue dog or shelter you could help someday
- ☐ Noted one small thing that made you smile about them today
- ☐ Told someone else your dog's Gotcha Day story today
- ☐ Took a breath and just appreciated this exact moment with them
- ☐ Marked the calendar for next year's Gotcha Day already

Keeping This Keepsake

A few tips for making this bundle last as long as the memories do.

- ☐ Print on slightly heavier paper (cardstock) for the certificate page
- ☐ Consider a simple frame for the certificate or a favorite photo page
- ☐ Store filled-in pages in a binder, folder, or scrapbook together
- ☐ Add new photo and log pages each year using this same file
- ☐ Keep a digital backup of your filled-in pages alongside the printed ones
- ☐ This is a personal keepsake, not veterinary or professional advice
- ☐ Every adoption story is different — use what fits yours and skip what doesn't
- ☐ Instant digital download — no physical item will be shipped
- ☐ Re-download your files anytime from Etsy's Purchases page